

Sunday, 9 August 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON Overcast 32° 20°	BIRMINGHAM Overcast 28° 19°	MANCHESTER Light drizzle 22° 17°	GLASGOW Drizzle 18° 13°
-------------------------------	-----------------------------------	--	-------------------------------

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1

Police are urging more victims to come forward as a sex offender who murdered one woman and attacked others was left free due to 'litany of failures'.

The Met and British Transport Police admit Simon Levy's second murder victim, Sheryl Wilkins, could have been saved. They are facing severe criticism over how the case was handled.

CRIME · UK
- 2

Obesity rates in England have doubled since 1993, with around seven million more adults now living with obesity.

Experts are highlighting the significant increase, noting the impact on public health. This trend shows a substantial shift in the nation's health profile over three decades.

HEALTH · UK
- 3

A mum has shared her story of becoming one of the 'rising number of hidden homeless' after fleeing her home with her daughter.

Jodie spent a year sleeping on sofas and floors, carrying her belongings in two bin bags. Her experience sheds light on the growing issue of homelessness that isn't always visible.

SOCIAL AFFAIRS · UK
- 4

Residents in Thetford have described how tensions over asylum seekers boiled over into violence, bringing disorder to the town.

The community recounts the breakdown of peace as protests escalated. This highlights the ongoing challenges and debates surrounding asylum policy and its local impact.

SOCIAL AFFAIRS · UK
- 5

Twenty walkers had to be rescued in just one day on the Skye Trail, prompting a warning from mountain rescue teams.

The Skye Mountain Rescue Team described it as one of their busiest days ever, from 7am to 8pm on Friday. They are urging hikers to be prepared and cautious on the popular route.

TRAVEL · UK

What's coming up

1 Fans are hoping for a new Fugees album after Lauryn Hill and Wyclef Jean revealed they are 'in an amazing place'.

Hill mentioned the band has gone through 'an incredible healing process' after 30 years since their last album. This news has sparked excitement about potential new music.

ON AIR – Would you be excited for new Fugees music after all these years? What's your favourite Fugees track?
MUSIC · COMING UP

2 Rihanna is 'in the studio' and 'cooking' up new music, according to her partner A\$AP Rocky.

The superstar singer hasn't released a full album since 2016, so fans have been eagerly awaiting new material. This update suggests a highly anticipated return to music is on the horizon.

ON AIR – What kind of music would you love to hear from Rihanna next? What's your favourite Rihanna hit?
MUSIC · COMING UP

3 Emmerdale actor Lawrence Robb, known for playing Mackenzie 'Mack' Boyd, has joined the Strictly Come Dancing line-up.

Robb, who also appeared in 'I Hate Suzie', is the latest star confirmed for the popular dancing competition. His inclusion will surely excite fans of the soap and the show.

ON AIR – Who would you love to see Lawrence Robb partnered with on Strictly? Do you think he'll be good on the dancefloor?
TV · COMING UP

4 Pop singer Self Esteem is set to make her cinematic debut in an upcoming film titled 'Mountain', set in the 1980s.

The artist, whose real name is Rebecca Lucy Taylor, will star in the movie from Welsh director Celyn Jones. This marks an exciting new venture for the acclaimed musician.

ON AIR – Which musicians have successfully transitioned into acting? Who would you like to see on the big screen?
FILM · COMING UP

5 A major Sir Billy Connolly exhibition, 'Billy Connolly's Big Wee Exhibition', is coming to Glasgow in 2027.

The exhibition will be held at the city's Kelvingrove Art Gallery from next June. It promises to celebrate the life and career of the beloved Scottish comedian.

ON AIR – What's your favourite Billy Connolly moment or joke? What makes him such a national treasure?
ARTS · COMING UP

On the schedule

1 **Arsenal have signed Brazilian midfielder Bruno Guimaraes from Newcastle, and fans can now watch his best Premier League moments.**

The Gunners have secured a significant talent, strengthening their midfield ahead of the new season. His arrival is a big talking point in the football world.

ON AIR – Arsenal fans, how do you feel about this signing? Newcastle supporters, will you miss him?

FOOTBALL · UK

2 **Manchester City have reportedly agreed a deal to sign Argentina goalkeeper Geronimo Rulli from Marseille.**

This move would bolster City's goalkeeping options as they prepare for the upcoming season. It's another big transfer in the Premier League.

ON AIR – Do you think this is a good move for Manchester City? What qualities does Rulli bring?

FOOTBALL · UK

3 **Ipswich Town have signed Serbia midfielder Sasa Lukic from Fulham for an undisclosed fee.**

This transfer sees Lukic move to Portman Road, adding strength to Ipswich's squad. It's an important acquisition as they look to compete in the league.

ON AIR – Ipswich fans, how do you feel about this new signing? What are your hopes for the season?

FOOTBALL · UK

4 **Partick Thistle secured a victory over Livingston in the Scottish Championship, with an early goal and an own goal sealing the win.**

Robbie Crawford's back-heel and a Cammy MacPherson own goal gave Partick Thistle the edge. It was a crucial match between two of the promotion favourites at Firhill.

ON AIR – Scottish football fans, what did you make of that result? Who do you think will be promoted this season?

FOOTBALL · UK

5 **Leeds Rhinos fought back to beat Wakefield Trinity 24-22 in a thrilling top-of-the-table Super League clash.**

The dramatic victory sees Leeds move four points clear at the top of the table. It was a fiercely contested match that kept fans on the edge of their seats.

ON AIR – What a game! Did you watch it? What was your favourite moment from the match?

RUGBY LEAGUE · UK

Quick hits

- 1 A new study highlights the growing trend of 'library tourism' where people visit libraries not just for books, but for their unique architecture and historical significance.**

From grand Victorian buildings to ultra-modern designs, libraries are becoming cultural landmarks, attracting visitors eager to explore their quiet beauty and community hubs. It's a lovely way to enjoy a bit of history and peace.

- 2 Researchers have discovered that 'the art of mending clothes' is experiencing a significant resurgence, driven by sustainability and a desire for unique style.**

People are embracing visible mending techniques, turning repairs into decorative features, and giving cherished garments a new lease of life. It's a wonderful blend of practicality and creativity.

- 3 A recent report indicates a surge in popularity for 'garden sharing' schemes, allowing those without outdoor space to cultivate a plot on someone else's land.**

These initiatives foster community spirit, promote local food growth, and help urban dwellers connect with nature, even if they don't have their own back garden. It's a blooming good idea!

- 4 Experts are praising the therapeutic benefits of 'listening to birdsong' for reducing stress and improving mood.**

Spending time tuning into the natural orchestra around us, whether in a park or from a window, is proving to be a simple yet effective way to boost well-being. A true symphony for the soul!

- 5 There's a growing appreciation for the traditional British 'village fete', with more communities revitalising these charming local events.**

From tombolas to bake sales and coconut shies, village fetes offer a delightful dose of nostalgia and a chance for local residents to come together and celebrate. What a lovely day out!

- 6 A new trend sees people embracing the 'slow art of letter writing' as a way to connect more meaningfully with friends and family.**

In an age of instant messages, the thoughtful process of putting pen to paper and sending a physical letter is becoming a cherished form of communication. There's nothing quite like receiving a proper letter.

- 7 The surprising popularity of 'collecting vintage postcards' is creating a fascinating window into the past.**

People are finding joy in the historical images, forgotten messages, and unique artwork on old postcards, offering a tangible connection to bygone eras. Each one tells a little story!

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 70% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we're trying to choose a new paint colour for a room, even if we know it might not be the most reliable method?

ANSWER: HOLDING UP A TINY SWATCH AND TRYING TO IMAGINE THE ENTIRE WALL!

Q Our survey said that over 65% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before enjoying a lovely, fresh slice of pizza. What is it?

ANSWER: FOLDING IT IN HALF LIKE A SANDWICH!

TALK TOPIC

- You know how sometimes you hear a 'jingle' from a really old advertisement, and it just instantly gets stuck in your head, even decades later?

What's that one jingle that, no matter how old it is, still pops into your mind and you can sing along to? Let's have a chuckle at those catchy old tunes!

- We all have those 'unexpectedly comfortable places' that aren't actually designed for sitting, but you just find yourself gravitating towards them for a quick rest.

Where's your go-to, slightly unconventional spot for a moment of unexpected comfort? Is it the bottom step of the stairs, a big cushion on the floor, or somewhere else entirely?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Nature.** Did you know that a group of ferrets is called a 'business'?

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Did you know that some species of mushroom can glow in the dark for up to three weeks after being picked?

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£25 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£3.8 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The world's largest officially recognised jigsaw puzzle has over 50,000 pieces.
- A typical cumulus cloud weighs about the same as 100 elephants.
- The 'smiley face' emoji was invented in 1982 by Scott Fahlman.
- Honey never spoils; archaeologists have found pots of honey in ancient Egyptian tombs that are still edible.
- The shortest complete English sentence is 'Go.'
- Bubble wrap was originally intended to be used as 3D wallpaper.
- The sound of a human yawn can make other people yawn, even if they just read about it.
- The small plastic tip on the end of a shoelace is called an aglet.

On this day

Day 221 of the year, 144 days left in 2026. Today Battle of Gangut Day (Russia); Christian feast day: Candida Maria of Jesus; Christian feast day: Edith Stein (St Teresa Benedicta of the Cross); Christian feast day: Firmus and Rusticus. Star sign Leo, birthstone Peridot.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1939 — Butch Warren, American bassist (died 2013)
- 2000 — Arlo Parks, British singer-songwriter
- 1986 — Tyler Smith, American singer-songwriter and bass player
- 1976 — Rhona Mitra, English actress and singer
- 1968 — Sam Fogarino, American drummer
- 1970 — Thomas Lennon, American actor and comedian
- 1985 — Anna Kendrick, American actress and singer
- 1976 — Jessica Capshaw, American actress

THE DAY TODAY

- 1944 — The United States Forest Service and the Wartime Advertising Council release posters featuring Smokey Bear for the first time.
- 2024 — Voepass Linhas Aéreas Flight 2283 crashes near Vinhedo, São Paulo, killing all 62 people on board.
- 1945 — The Red Army invades Japanese-occupied Manchuria.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1999 — Russian president Boris Yeltsin fires his prime minister, Sergei Stepashin, and for the fourth time fires his entire cabinet.
- 1993 — The Liberal Democratic Party of Japan loses a 38-year hold on national leadership.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1942 — World War II: Battle of Savo Island: Allied naval forces protecting their amphibious forces during the initial stages of the Battle of Guadalcanal are surprised and defeated by an Imperial Japanese Navy cruiser force.
- 1973 — Mars 7 is launched from the USSR.

- 1945 — World War II: Nagasaki is devastated when an atomic bomb, Fat Man, is dropped by the United States B-29 Bockscar. Thirty-five thousand people are killed outright, including 23,200–28,200 Japanese war workers, 2,000 Korean forced workers, and 150 Japanese soldiers.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 222 of the year, 143 days left in 2026. Today Argentine Air Force Day (Argentina); Christian feast day: Bessus; Christian feast day: Blane (Roman Catholic Church); Christian feast day: Geraint of Dumnonia. Star sign Leo, birthstone Peridot.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1958 — Jack Richards, English cricketer, coach, and manager
- 1966 — Charlie Dimmock, English gardener and television host
- 1950 — Patti Austin, American singer-songwriter
- 1948 — Nick Stringer, English actor
- 1957 — Fred Ho, American saxophonist, composer, and playwright (died 2014)
- 1984 — Jigar Naik, English cricketer
- 1980 — Aaron Staton, American actor
- 1952 — Diane Venora, American actress

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1998 — HRH Prince Al-Muhtadee Billah is proclaimed the crown prince of Brunei with a Royal Proclamation.
- 1977 — In Yonkers, New York, 24-year-old postal employee David Berkowitz ("Son of Sam") is arrested for a series of killings in the New York City area over the period of one year.
- 2024 — Israel strikes Al-Tabaheen school in eastern Gaza City, killing at least 80 Palestinians.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1999 — One person is killed and five people are injured in the Los Angeles Jewish Community Center shooting.
- 1988 — Japanese American internment: U.S. President Ronald Reagan signs the Civil Liberties Act of 1988, providing \$20,000 payments to Japanese Americans who were either interned in or relocated by the United States during World War II.

Coming to cinemas

AUGUST 2026	
FRI 14	Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie
FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome
SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)
OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

On the sporting calendar

AUGUST 2026

W/C 10	Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)
SAT 15	Premier League season begins (2026/27)
22–23	Belgian Grand Prix (F1)